Group and solo flights

Does flying in a group change how a paraglider moves?

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Abstract

Do paragliders move differently when they fly in a group? Group time differs from solo flight in many ways, but so do the pilots who fly in groups, the places and hours where groups form, and the moments pilots choose to fly together. We measure the motion by the local exponent $H_{\mathrm{loc}}(\tau)$ of the time-averaged mean squared displacement and by statistics of the climbs and glides, and take each of the other causes away with one test: contrasts within strata of site, day and hour and within the same flight; solo flights reweighted to the zones and hours of the groups; the same route flown alone on another day; the same flight before, during and after a group. Over a quarter of an hour a pilot in a group progresses straighter. $\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$ is $+0.037$ against the same flight alone and $+0.043$ against the same flights alone at the same site, day and hour, while who flies in groups accounts for $+0.003$. Reweighting the solo flights to the zones and hours where groups fly lowers the long-lag gap by at most a fifth; on the half of the group time that can be matched, fixing the route lowers it by about 71%; and on the same flight the straighter progress starts and stops with the group. Within one glide or climb the progress is no straighter. Glides are faster and flatter in a group, both within strata and on the same flight before and after; pilots also climb more, but on the same flight the climbs change when the group forms and not when it breaks. Most of this is there with two pilots, and the pilot ahead ends searches in a climb as often as the one behind. The tests fix the pilot, the place, the route, the hour and the moment, but not the conditions of the day that bring pilots together: the rest of the effect goes with flying together, and whether the group causes it stays open.

1 Introduction

The thesis studies how paraglider pilots move in cross-country flight: how long they climb, how far they glide, how their displacement grows with time. Flying in a group could change all of this. In soaring birds, social information on the position of thermals changes the gliding strategy [2], and in a migrating flock a few individuals find the thermals while the others follow them [1]. The note *Group flights in free flight* (`ideas/group-identification`) labels every instant of every flight of the FFVL archive as solo or in a group. This report asks whether, on the same archive, pilots move differently when they fly in a group.

A raw comparison cannot answer, because group time differs from solo flight in four other ways.

(i) **The pilots.** Those who fly in groups may be more experienced, or fly faster wings.
(ii) **The place.** Groups form on some sites and routes, where any pilot may progress straighter.
(iii) **The day and the hour.** Group time gathers around midday and on some days more than others, and the air of that day and hour acts on every pilot.
(iv) **The moment.** Pilots may join others when the progress is straight anyway, along a convergence line or a ridge, and the straight progress would then come before the group.

Each of these can produce a difference between group and solo time with no effect of the group. The report removes them one at a time. Section 2 fixes the populations and the measures, and Section 3 shows the raw difference. Contrasts within strata of site, day and hour, and within the same flight, separate the pilots, the day and the hour from the group (Section 4); reweighting the solo flights to the zones and hours where groups fly tests the place (Section 5); the same route flown alone on another day tests the route inside a zone (Section 6); the same flight before, during and after a group tests the moment (Section 7). What survives the four tests we call the group effect. Section 8 looks inside the group, at its size and at who leads, and Section 9 says what can and cannot be concluded.

2 Data and measures

Which flights, which populations, and which measures of the motion?

Flights and groups. We use 156 391 paraglider and 6 094 hang-glider flights on 6 209 days, the cleaned tracks of the old repository (soaring, tag `legacy-final`). A flight is analysed after its *departure*, the first fix 3 km from the takeoff; before it the pilot counts as neither solo nor in a group. The measures of the motion use loggers of at most 10 s; the phases (climb, search, glide) are Vilpellet's runs and exist on the flights logged every second, about 70% of the paragliders. The groups are those of the note, with $\delta = 2$ min, $\varepsilon_h = 500$ m, $\varepsilon_z = 300$ m, $\theta_{\max} = 45°$, $g = 2$ min and $q = 0.1$, hence contacts of at least $\tau^* = 38.1$ min (its sections 3–6). A contact means shared air within sight; it does not prove interaction.

What the grouping gives. Of the 154 598 paraglider flights with a logger of at most 10 s, 33 501 (21.7%) fly in a group at some point; of the 6 039 hang-glider flights, 418 (6.9%). Group time is 12.8% of all paraglider flight time after the departure, and on average 45% of the time of a group flight. The 36 575 pair intervals last 40 to 96 min (10th to 90th percentile; median 52 min) and form 40 051 groups in 17 169 episodes. Half of the episodes have two flights, 1% have more than 9, the largest has 53. By the size of the group, the paraglider group time is: 2 pilots 64%, 3 pilots 19%, 4 pilots 8%, 5-6 pilots 6%, 7+ pilots 3% (the largest group has 27 pilots). In contact, one pilot is behind the other by a median of 20 s (75% within 45 s).

Populations. Three populations of stretches of flight.

- S, *solo flights*: flights never in a group.
- G, *group time*: the stretches of a flight inside a group, a fixed set of flights linked by contacts over a maximal interval. G_n is the group time in groups of n pilots; "n pilots" always means the size of the group at that instant.
- A, *the same flights alone*: the stretches of the group flights outside any group. Nearly every group flight has some (Table 4, Appendix E), so A has nearly the pilots, gliders, loggers and days of G, and serves as its control.

The motion over every lag. The horizontal position $\mathbf{r}(t)$ of a flight is read on a 10-s grid of its clock. A *piece* is the part of a stretch within one segment of the track; it enters only if it lasts at least 1250 s, so that every population keeps the same flights at all 21 lags from 10 to 1000 s. For a flight f and a population, the time-averaged mean squared displacement pools the origins of all its pieces in that population,

$$\overline{\delta_f^2}(\tau) = \frac{1}{N_f(\tau)} \sum_t \left\| \mathbf{r}(t+\tau) - \mathbf{r}(t) \right\|^2, \tag{1}$$

where t runs over the $N_f(\tau)$ origins with t and $t+\tau$ in the same piece, and the ensemble $\mathrm{MSD}(\tau)$ is the mean of $\overline{\delta_f^2}(\tau)$ over the flights, one weight per flight. With $\mathrm{MSD}(\tau) \propto \tau^{2H}$, H is half the slope of $\log \mathrm{MSD}$ against $\log \tau$ over all lags: $H = 1$ for a straight line, $H = 1/2$ for a random walk. $H_{\mathrm{loc}}(\tau)$ is the same slope over the lags within ± 0.25 decades of τ (Appendix A). We read it at two scales: $\tau = 100$ s, within one climb or one glide, and $\tau = 1000$ s (lags 580–1000 s), over one to two climb–glide cycles.

Climbs and glides. Each phase run goes whole to the population of the stretch that holds its middle, and each statistic is a ratio of sums over the runs of a population, so long phases weigh more. Of the twelve statistics measured, five are not explained by the others and are the ones drawn (Appendix B): the share of time in climb; the share of searches that end in a climb; the climb rate, total height gained over total climb time; the glide speed, total straight-line distance over total glide time; and the glide ratio, total distance over total height lost, replaced in stratified contrasts by its inverse, the height lost per kilometre of glide. The tables also give the cross-country speed, the straight-line distance covered in 30 min averaged over every origin, which the five explain.

Strata. A *zone* is a cell of 25 km containing the middle of a piece; a *site-day* holds the flights of one day whose takeoffs lie within 3 km; the *hour* is the local hour of the middle of a piece or a run.

Uncertainty. Bands are 5–95% of bootstrap draws that resample whole dependency blocks, the flights tied by sharing episodes, and recompute the statistic: the blocks of the note for the pooled values of Tables 4 and 10 (1000 draws); blocks that also join the flights of a site-day for every contrast (200 draws, the same for every statistic). Every difference is computed draw by draw and has its own band. The bands measure the sampling of blocks; the choice of q is tested in Appendix C.

What we keep. Three populations, S, G and A; two scales of the motion, $H_{\mathrm{loc}}(100\ \mathrm{s})$ and $H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$; five statistics of climbs and glides; bands from blocks of flights that are not independent.

3 The raw difference

How do group time and solo flights differ before any control?

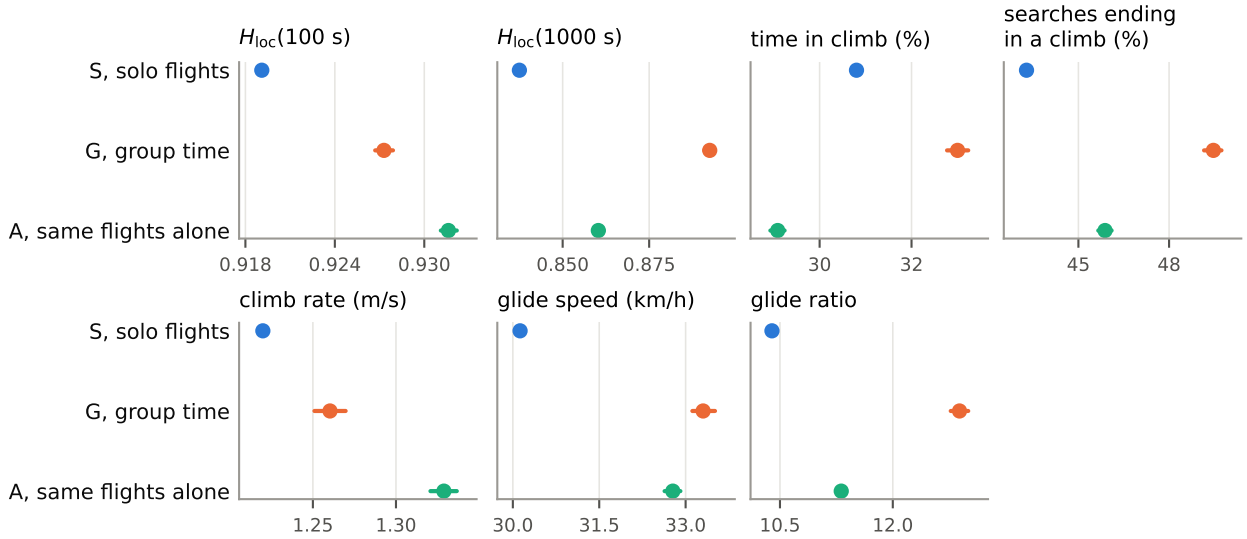


Figure 1: Pooled statistics of S, G and A (paragliders), with 5–95% bands. Exponents on loggers of at most 10 s, phases on 1 Hz flights. Values in Table 4.

Group time progresses straighter over long lags than solo flights: $H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$ is 0.893 in group time against 0.837 in solo flights. It also spends more time climbing, ends more searches in a climb, glides faster and glides flatter, with a glide ratio of 12.9 against 10.4 (Figure 1; the curves over every lag are in Appendix D). The same flights alone sit between the two at long lags (0.860) and have the highest climb rate. Part of the raw difference may therefore belong to who flies in groups, and to where and when they fly.

What we keep. A difference to explain, largest at long lags and in the glides. The next three sections ask how much of it is the group.

4 Group or pilots? Contrasts within strata

How much of the difference belongs to who flies in groups, and how much to the group, once the day, the site and the hour are fixed?

Contrast. For a statistic X and two populations P and Q, each stratum s that holds both gives $D_s = X_{P,s} - X_{Q,s}$, computed as on the whole archive (ensemble MSD, ratios of sums). The contrast is their weighted mean,

$$\Delta_{P-Q} = \frac{\sum_s w_s D_s}{\sum_s w_s}, \qquad w_s = \frac{n_{P,s}\, n_{Q,s}}{n_{P,s} + n_{Q,s}}, \tag{2}$$

with $n_{P,s}$ and $n_{Q,s}$ the flights of each population in s. The weight is half the harmonic mean of the two counts: a stratum counts as much as its smaller side allows. For the exponents, D_s is the difference of log MSD at every lag, and ΔH and ΔH_{loc} are half the slopes of its weighted mean, over all lags and within ± 0.25 decades.

Five contrasts (Figure 2; values with bands in Table 5, Appendix E):

- G − S pooled: the raw difference;
- G − S within site-day and hour: day, site and hour fixed;
- A − S within site-day and hour: *selection*, how the flights that fly in groups differ from solo flights when they fly alone;
- G − A within the flight, the stratum being one flight: pilot, glider, logger, day and site fixed, the hour free;

- G − A within site-day and hour: day, site and hour fixed, the pilots different.

The last two estimate the group effect and fail in opposite ways. Within the flight, group time falls around midday and the time alone of the same flight earlier and later (section 7 of the note), so the hour differs; within site-day and hour, the hour is the same but the pilots differ. Where the two agree, neither the hour nor the pilot explains the difference.

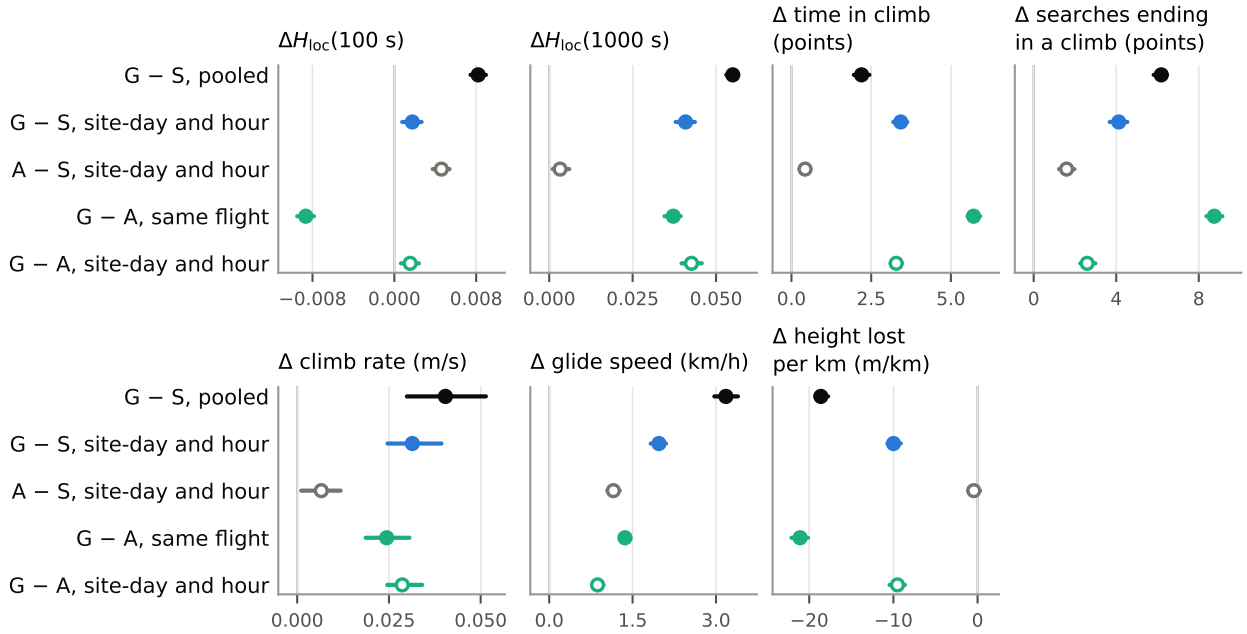


Figure 2: Each statistic (panel) for the five contrasts (rows), with 5–95% bands. Colour names the population subtracted (S blue, A green, selection grey); open points are selection and the second estimate of the group effect. Shares of time in points; lower height lost per km is a better glide.

Results (Figure 2). The straighter progress over 1000 s survives both estimates of the group effect, $\Delta H_{\text{loc}}(1000\text{ s}) = +0.037$ within the flight and $+0.043$ at the same site-day and hour, while selection gives $+0.003$. At 100 s the two estimates disagree in sign: within the flight the hour differs, and fixing it removes the difference (Figure 3, right). In a group pilots spend more time climbing, end more searches in a climb, climb faster, and glide faster and flatter, in both estimates; pooled, G climbs slower than A (Figure 1), within strata faster. Except the climb rate, these statistics are larger within the flight than at the same site-day and hour, up to three times for the searches, as expected if the hour adds to them; for them the latter are the conservative estimates. Selection is small for the motion and the time in climb, over a third of the searches that end in a climb, and over half of the faster glides: group pilots glide faster even alone.

What we keep. With the pilot fixed, or with the day, site and hour fixed, group time progresses straighter over a quarter of an hour, climbs more and glides faster and flatter. Who flies in groups explains little of the straighter progress and over half of the faster glides.

5 Group or place? Solo flights where groups fly

Do groups fly where, and when, any pilot would progress straighter? If so, solo flights compared on the same ground and at the same hours would match group time.

Reweighting. Each piece gets a stratum from its middle, in four stratifications from coarse to fine: zone, zone×month, zone×hour, site-day×hour. The solo flights are then given the mix of the group over the strata (direct standardisation):

$$\text{MSD}_{\text{S}|\text{G}}(\tau) = \frac{\sum_s n_{\text{G},s}\,\text{MSD}_{\text{S},s}(\tau)}{\sum_s n_{\text{G},s}}, \tag{3}$$

with $n_{\text{G},s}$ the units of G in stratum s (a flight counts once per stratum it crosses) and $\text{MSD}_{\text{S},s}$ the ensemble MSD of the solo units of s. In the statistic, S then flies where and when G flies. G is taken on the strata it

shares with S, so the two curves have the same support; the same is done for A. "As is" is the comparison on the same strata without the reweighting.

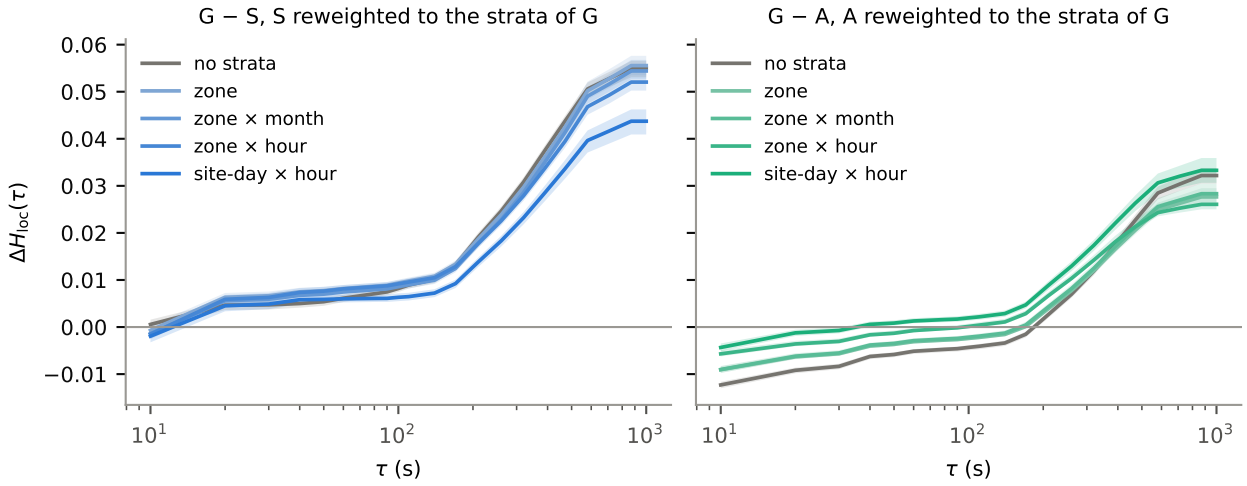


Figure 3: $\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(\tau)$ over every lag: G minus S (left) and G minus A (right), the other population reweighted to the strata of G, with 5–95% bands; one line per stratification, finer strata darker, grey without strata. The curves themselves are in Figure 11.

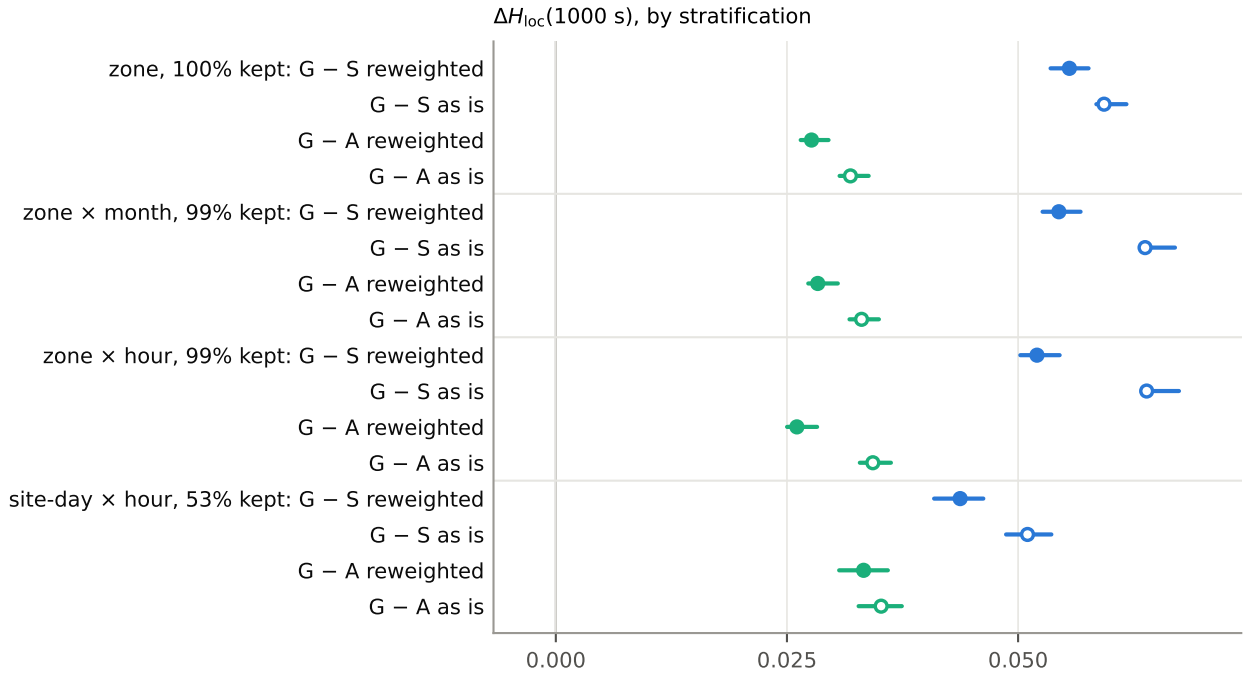


Figure 4: $\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$ by stratification, with the share of G kept: G − S and G − A, the other population reweighted to the strata of G (filled) and as is on the same strata (open). Values with the fitted ΔH in Table 6.

Results. The gap opens above $\tau \approx 150$ s and grows up to the longest lag (Figure 3). Reweighting the solo flights to the strata of the groups lowers the long-lag gap of the same strata little (Figure 4, filled against open points): by 6% with the zones alone and by at most a fifth with the months or the hours, although solo pilots do fly where groups fly (100% of G has a solo counterpart in its cell). Against the same flights alone the gap is smaller, and the reweighting lowers it by a similar share. At the same site-day and hour the reweighted G − A (+0.033) differs from the contrast of Section 4 on the same strata (+0.043) only through the weights, $n_{\mathrm{G},s}$ here and the half harmonic mean there: the effect varies between strata, so its average depends on how they are weighted.

Limits. Cells are 25 km, placed by the middle of a piece; the terrain inside a cell is not controlled, and a group may choose better air within it, which is then part of what we call the group effect. Paragliders only.

What we keep. Reweighting the solo flights to the zones, months and hours where groups fly lowers the long-lag gap by at most a fifth, much less with the zone alone; the rest stays at the same site, day and hour. Inside a zone, the route itself remains to be tested.

6 Group or route? The same route flown alone

A zone is 25 km wide. Inside it a convergence line, a ridge or a valley can let any pilot progress straight, and can bring pilots together on it: the route would then explain both the group and the straight progress. Does group time progress straighter than the same route flown alone?

Matching. The candidates are the 52 371 paraglider flights that never had a contact of any length. A site joins the takeoffs within 1 km across dates, and its flights are placed in one east–north frame. A piece of group time and a candidate from the same site on another day match when at least 80% of the points of the piece, one every 30 s, lie within $\rho = 500$ m of the candidate's track, and the candidate flew them the same way. The candidate's segment, between its points nearest to the first and to the last of them, is measured as the pieces of Section 2 if it lasts at least 1250 s; each piece keeps at most 20 matches, the most covered first.

Comparison. In analogy with Section 5, the stratum is the piece: the ensemble MSD of the matched pieces is compared with that of their segments reweighted to one piece per stratum, Eq. (3). Both sides are means of many MSDs before their logarithm. The baseline compares the same pieces with the solo flights of their site-day and hour, so that the two differences refer to the same group time. A second set keeps only the matches of the same season and hour (month within one, local hour within two).

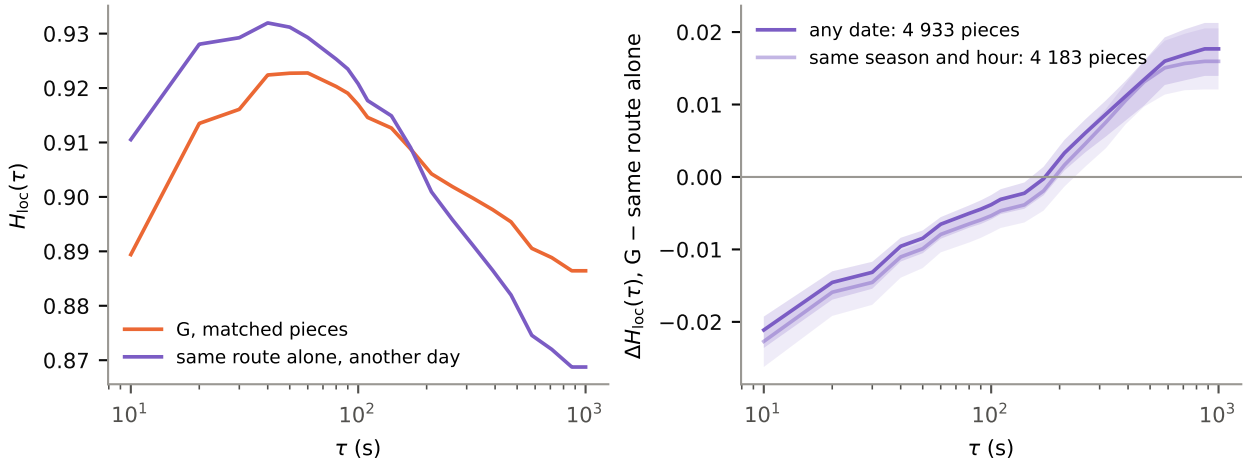


Figure 5: Left: $H_{loc}(\tau)$ of the matched pieces of group time (orange) and of the same routes flown alone on another day (purple). Right: their difference over every lag, any date and, lighter, same season and hour, with 5–95% bands.

Results. Of a random sample of 10 000 pieces, 4 933 have matches, about half. Against the same route flown alone the long-lag gap is less than a third of the gap of the same pieces against the solo flights of their site-day and hour (Figures 5 and 8): fixing the route lowers it by 71% (74% with the same season and hour), and every radius and cover gives the same (Figure 12). These pieces lie on frequented routes: their gap at the same site-day and hour, $+0.060$, is larger than the $+0.041$ of all the group time. At short lags group time is less straight than the same route flown alone (Figure 5, right), so the fitted H hardly differs.

Limits. The days differ: season and hour are matched, the weather of the day is not. The pilots who never meet anyone may differ from those who fly in groups, and this test has no selection contrast to measure it. Only the pieces on routes flown alone on other days enter, about half of them, on a sample of the pieces.

What we keep. Where the route can be matched, fixing it lowers the straighter progress of groups over a quarter of an hour by about 71%; the rest goes with flying together.

7 Group or moment? The same flight before, during and after

Do pilots fly together in the moments when the progress is straight anyway? If so, the same flight would already be straight just before the group forms, and still just after it breaks.

Windows. Every stretch of group time is an *event*, with up to four windows of length $W = 50$ min on the clock of the same flight: *start* and *end*, the first and last W of the group, when it lasts at least W; *before* and *after*, the last W of the solo stretch that precedes the group and the first W of the one that follows it, when that solo stretch lasts at least W, whatever the length of the group. A window of 50 min holds about 200 origins at $\tau = 1000$ s. For two windows the ensemble MSD is taken on the events that have both, and their difference is read on H_{loc} and on the phase statistics. Entering is start minus before; leaving is end minus after, group minus alone in both cases. The two readings predict different things:

- if the straighter progress belongs to the group, it appears on entering and on leaving, and before and after are alike;
- if it belongs to the moment, before is already high, and the changes are those of any two consecutive windows.

Controls. Two consecutive windows with no change of state, drawn in the solo time of the group flights (A) and in solo flights (S), measure how much a flight drifts from one window to the next, later minus earlier. Entering has the same time order as the controls; leaving has the opposite one, so on leaving the drift enters with the opposite sign.

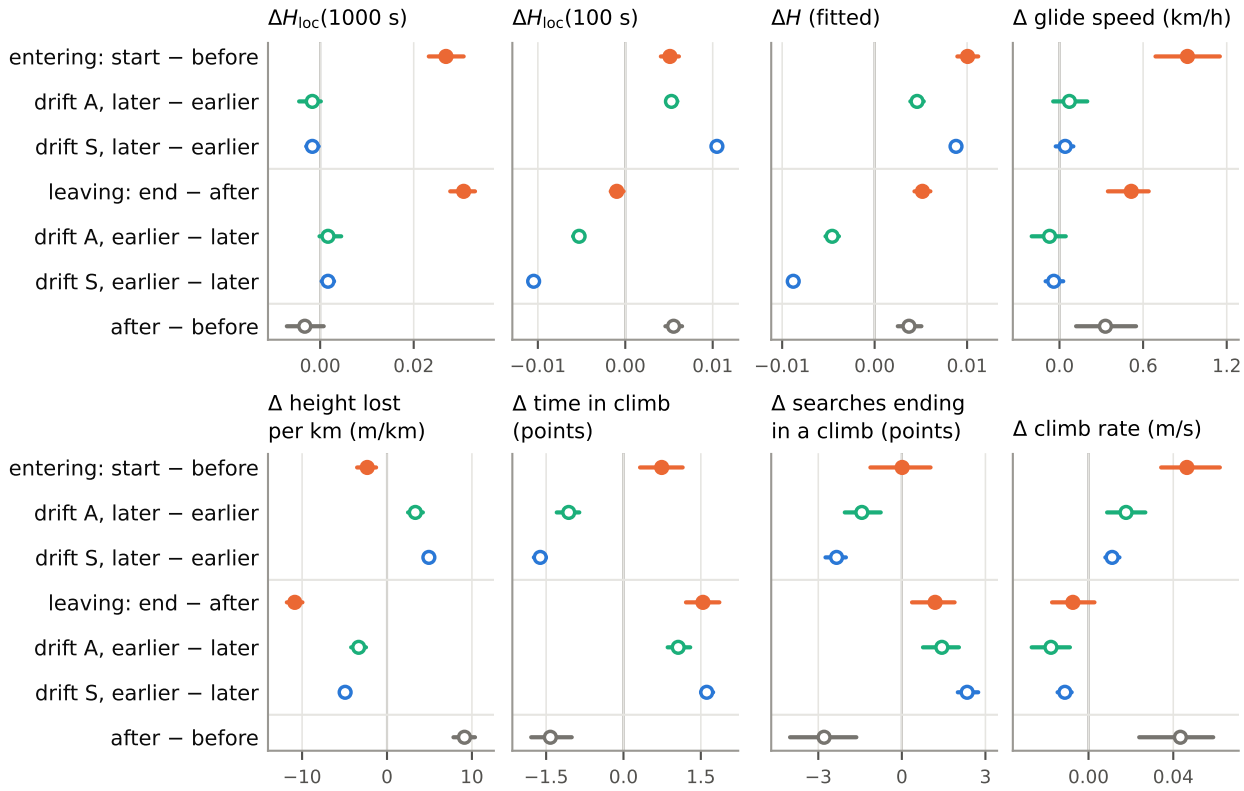


Figure 6: Group minus alone on entering (start − before) and on leaving (end − after), each above the drift it is read against: the controls later minus earlier for entering, earlier minus later for leaving. Last row: after − before. The curves over every lag are in Figure 14, the values in Tables 8 and 9, the four windows in Figure 13.

Results (Figure 6). The first prediction holds at long lags: $\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$ is $+0.027$ entering and $+0.031$ leaving, against drifts near zero, and after minus before is -0.003: a step close to the within-flight estimate of Section 4. At 100 s entering changes nothing beyond the drift, and on the fitted H it exceeds the drift of A but not that of S; on leaving the group window stays above both drifts, at 100 s and on H: a small asymmetry, which we do not interpret. Glides are faster and flatter in the group both ways, by similar amounts once each drift is taken with its sign. The climb statistics rise on entering beyond the drift and do not fall on leaving beyond it.

Limits. The windows fix the pilot, the glider, the day and the slow drift of the flight, not what brings pilots together: a convergence line, a ridge or a common route may last as long as the group and straighten the progress by itself, and two pilots must move alike to stay within 500 m for long. The events are long groups with solo flight beside them (6 524 entries, 13 643 exits). With windows of 21 min the step at 1000 s is much smaller, since such a window holds fewer than thirty origins at that lag; the test at that lag needs windows of 50 min (Appendix F).

What we keep. With windows of 50 min, on the same flight the straighter progress over a quarter of an hour starts with the group and stops with it, and the glides change with it both ways; the moment of joining does not explain them. The climbs change when the group forms and not when it breaks, so for them the moment remains a possible cause.

8 Inside the group: size and leader

Does the effect grow with the number of pilots, and does the pilot ahead fly differently from the one behind?

8.1 Size of the group

The group time is cut where the group changes, so every stretch has a fixed number of pilots n (2, 3, 4, 5–6, 7+), and a flight can contribute to several sizes. Two contrasts of Eq. (2) follow the size: $G_n - A$ within the flight, and $G_n - G_2$ at the same site-day and hour, which asks whether a group does more than a pair.

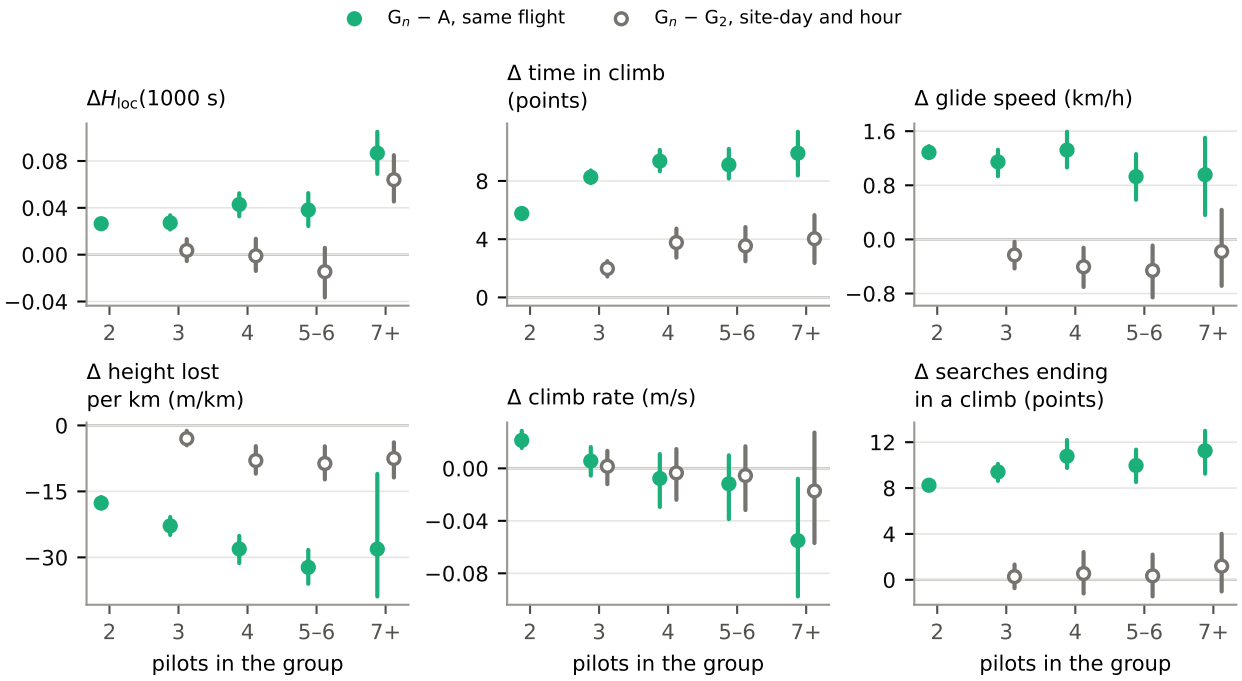


Figure 7: By the number of pilots n, with 5–95% bands. Green: $G_n - A$ within the flight. Grey, open: $G_n - G_2$ at the same site-day and hour. Values in Table 11.

Pooled, $H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$ rises with n while the same flights alone hardly change (Appendix D; values in Table 10). Within the flight the effect grows from +0.026 with 2 pilots to +0.087 with 7+ (Figure 7, green); there the day and the site are fixed, so the growth comes from the hour or from the flights that join large groups. At the same site-day and hour groups of 3 to 6 progress like pairs; only 7+ stands apart, 3% of the group time, perhaps competition gaggles flying a set task, which the archive does not flag. At the same place and hour larger groups spend more time climbing and glide flatter, but a little slower, than pairs, with most of the change from 2 to 4 pilots. On six single site-days the differences between days exceed those between sizes (Appendix G).

8.2 Leader and follower

In groups of two pilots, the signed median delay ℓ_{med} of the pair interval (Appendix B of the note) says who passes first: the leader, when the other passes at least 15 s later; otherwise the two fly abreast (35% of the

pairs). Leader and follower are compared within the same group, the group being the stratum of Eq. (2) (Appendix H). The pilot ahead climbs more, climbs a little faster, glides faster and glides as flat. The share of searches that end in a climb does not differ (-0.01 [-1.03, $+0.83$] points): on this measure the follower shows no sign of finding thermals through the leader. How groups form and break and whether the same pilots lead are in section 7 of the note.

What we keep. Most of the effect is there with two pilots. Beyond a pair, at the same site-day and hour, size adds climbing and flatter but slightly slower glides, and no straighter progress, except in the rare groups of 7 or more. The leader is a little faster, and ends searches in a climb as often as the follower.

9 What can and cannot be concluded

The raw difference between group time and solo flights is real, and its long-lag part survives the tests (Figure 8), but where the route can be matched, most of it goes with the route. With the pilot fixed, or with the day, site and hour fixed, a group progresses straighter over a quarter of an hour (Section 4); reweighting the solo flights to the zones and hours where groups fly lowers the long-lag gap by at most a fifth (Section 5); on the half of the group time that can be matched, fixing the route lowers it by about 71% (Section 6); on the same flight the straighter progress starts and stops with the group (Section 7). At 100 s, within one glide or climb, the progress is no straighter: the difference appears only at lags of one to two climb–glide cycles. Faster and flatter glides pass the contrasts and the before-and-after test; the climbs pass the contrasts but change only when the group forms. Two pilots carry most of it (Section 8).

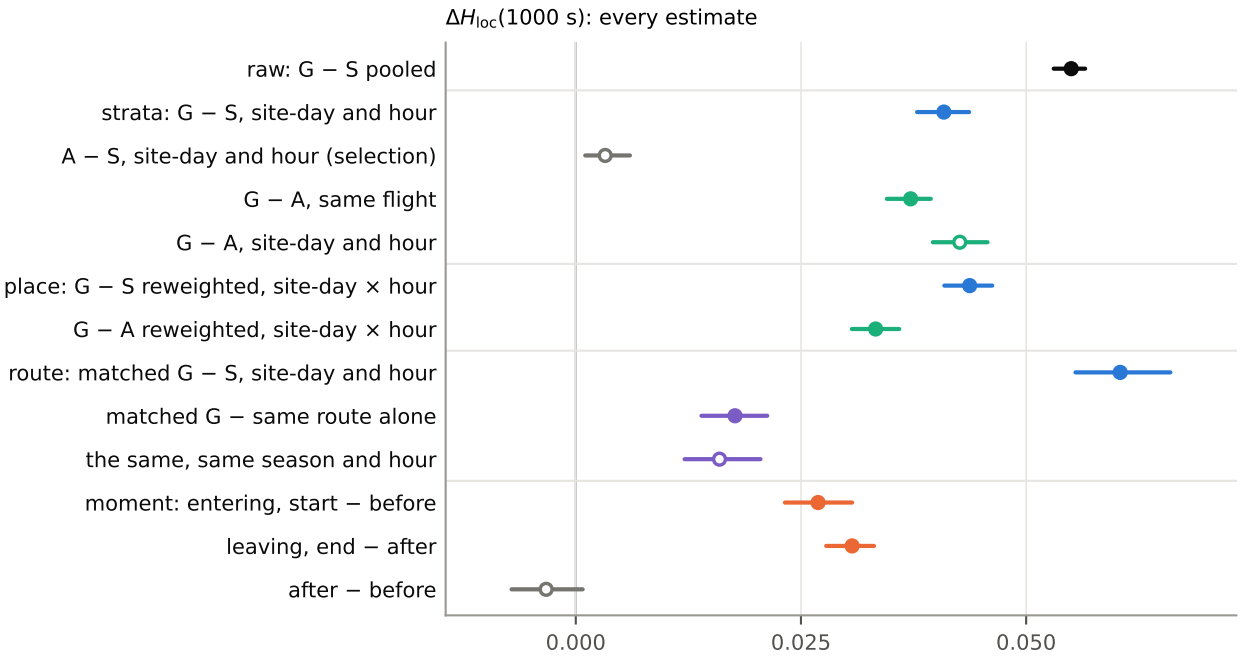


Figure 8: Every estimate of the long-lag difference, from the raw one to the four tests, with 5–95% bands. The route rows refer to the matched pieces only. Values, with the drifts of the before-and-after test, in Table 12.

Supported

- the progress over a quarter of an hour is straighter in a group, with the pilot fixed (+0.037) and with the day, site and hour fixed (+0.043);
- where the route can be matched, fixing it lowers this advantage by about 71%; the rest goes with flying together;
- no increase of $H_{\mathrm{loc}}(100\ \mathrm{s})$, within one glide or climb;
- on the same flight the straighter progress starts and stops with the group, and before and after are alike;
- faster and flatter glides, within strata and on the same flight both ways;
- more time climbing, more searches that end in a climb and a higher climb rate within strata (pooled, G climbed slower than A); on the same flight these rise when the group forms but do not fall when it breaks;
- selection explains little of the straighter progress, over a third of the searches that end in a climb and over half of the faster glides;
- the leader is a little faster and ends searches in a climb as often as the follower.

Not supported

- that the group *causes* the effect: the tests fix pilot, day, site, hour, zone and the drift of the flight and the route flown, but not the conditions of the day that bring pilots together (a line or a thermal working that day) nor the coordination needed to stay in contact;
- that larger groups progress straighter than pairs at the same site-day and hour, up to six pilots.

Caveats

- the glide statistics are partly fixed by definition, since headings must be aligned in glide for a contact;
- groups of 7 or more may be competition gaggles, which the archive does not flag;
- the route test compares different days, and pilots who never meet anyone with pilots in groups;
- the leader is assigned from ℓ_{med}, which is uncertain in thermals (note, Appendix B).

Open. The phases exist on 1 Hz flights only: the same analyses on the tracks of xc-dynamics, with phases on all loggers, and on hang gliders, which have few group flights (Appendix D), remain to be done. The reproduction of the report is in Appendix J, and the checks of the viewer and of the analyses in Appendix I.

References

[1] A. Flack, M. Nagy, W. Fiedler, I. D. Couzin, M. Wikelski. From local collective behavior to global migratory patterns in white storks. *Science* 360(6391):911–914, 2018.

[2] H. J. Williams, A. J. King, O. Duriez, L. Börger, E. L. C. Shepard. Social eavesdropping allows for a more risky gliding strategy by thermal-soaring birds. *Journal of the Royal Society Interface* 15:20180578, 2018.

A How H and H_{loc} are computed

$\mathrm{MSD}(\tau) \propto \tau^{2H}$, so $\log_{10}\mathrm{MSD} = 2H\log_{10}\tau + c$. H is half the slope of the least-squares line over all 21 lags (equal weight per lag). $H_{\mathrm{loc}}(\tau_c)$ is half the slope of the line fitted on the lags with $|\log_{10}\tau - \log_{10}\tau_c| \leq 0.25$ (a factor 1.78 on each side), equal weight; where fewer than 3 lags lie in the window, the 3 nearest are used. It is a windowed regression over about half a decade. ΔH and ΔH_{loc} of two curves are the differences of the fitted values; for a stratified average they are the same regression on the averaged $\Delta\log\mathrm{MSD}$ (linear: slope of a difference = difference of slopes). Bands: the same computation on each bootstrap draw, percentiles lag by lag.

τ (s)	lags used	τ (s)	lags used	τ (s)	lags used
10	10–30 (3 nearest)	90	60–140	320	210–470
20	20–40 (3 nearest)	100	60–170	390	260–580
30	20–50	110	80–170	470	320–710
40	30–60	140	80–210	580	390–1000
50	30–80	170	100–260	710	470–1000
60	40–100	210	140–320	870	580–1000
80	50–140	260	170–390	1000	580–1000

Table 1: Lags of the window of each H_{loc} value. At 10 and 20 s the window is not centred; at 870 and 1000 s it is cut at 1000 s and the two values use the same lags, so the end of the curve flattens by construction. The window resolves nothing narrower than about half a decade.

B Which statistics are drawn

Ratios. Ratios are sums of numerators over sums of denominators over the runs of a population (a run goes to the stretch that holds its middle). In a small stratum a glide in rising air has almost no height lost, the glide ratio diverges and its average over strata is unstable; stratified contrasts use the *height lost per km of glide*, the inverse. Pooled tables keep the glide ratio.

Redundancy. Unit: a population on a site-day with at least 25 flights (119 units). A statistic is redundant when the others explain most of it across units (R^2 of its linear regression on them); backward elimination drops the most explained until every $R^2 \leq 0.5$. The four shares of time sum to 100%, so one of them goes first.

statistic	status	R^2 on the five drawn
time in climb (%)	drawn	0.23
searches that end in a climb (%)	drawn	0.41
climb rate (m/s)	drawn	0.20
glide speed (km/h)	drawn	0.26
glide ratio	drawn	0.38
time in transition (%)	dropped, number 1, R^2 1.00 when dropped	0.83
height gained per climb (m)	dropped, number 2, R^2 0.98 when dropped	0.91
climbs that start after a search (%)	dropped, number 3, R^2 0.93 when dropped	0.77
cross-country speed over 30 min (km/h)	dropped, number 4, R^2 0.93 when dropped	0.90
time in a search in vain (%)	dropped, number 5, R^2 0.88 when dropped	0.71
climbs per hour	dropped, number 6, R^2 0.72 when dropped	0.71
time in a search that ends in a climb (%)	dropped, number 7, R^2 0.65 when dropped	0.65

Table 2: Five statistics remain; the others are explained by them.

C Robustness to the threshold

With $q = 0.2$ a contact needs only 26.4 min: groups are more and shorter, and up to one contact in five may be chance.

	$q = 0.1$, $\tau^* = 38.1$ min	$q = 0.2$, $\tau^* = 26.4$ min
group flights (TA-MSD)	33 435	48 777
$H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$, S	0.837	0.836
$H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$, A	0.860	0.854
$H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$, G	0.893	0.892
$\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$, G − A same flight	+0.037 [+0.035, +0.039]	+0.032 [+0.029, +0.035]
$\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$, G − A same s-d-h	+0.043 [+0.040, +0.046]	+0.042 [+0.040, +0.044]
$\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$, A − S same s-d-h	+0.003 [+0.001, +0.006]	+0.002 [−0.001, +0.005]
$\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(100\ \mathrm{s})$, G − A same flight	−0.009 [−0.009, −0.008]	−0.016 [−0.017, −0.015]
$\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(100\ \mathrm{s})$, G − A same s-d-h	+0.002 [+0.001, +0.002]	−0.004 [−0.005, −0.003]
Δ searches to climb, G − A same s-d-h (points)	+2.6 [+2.3, +3.0]	+3.4 [+3.0, +3.7]
Δ climb rate, G − A same s-d-h (m/s)	+0.029 [+0.025, +0.034]	+0.024 [+0.020, +0.029]
Δ height lost per km, G − A same s-d-h (m/km)	−9.5 [−10.5, −8.6]	−11.5 [−12.2, −10.9]
Δ cross-country speed, G − A same s-d-h (km/h)	+1.29 [+1.16, +1.41]	+1.14 [+1.01, +1.30]

Table 3: The main results with the two thresholds (s-d-h: same site-day and hour). Every result at 1000 s and every phase statistic keeps its sign; at 100 s the estimates turn slightly negative, consistent with no effect within one phase.

D Pooled curves, hang gliders and sizes

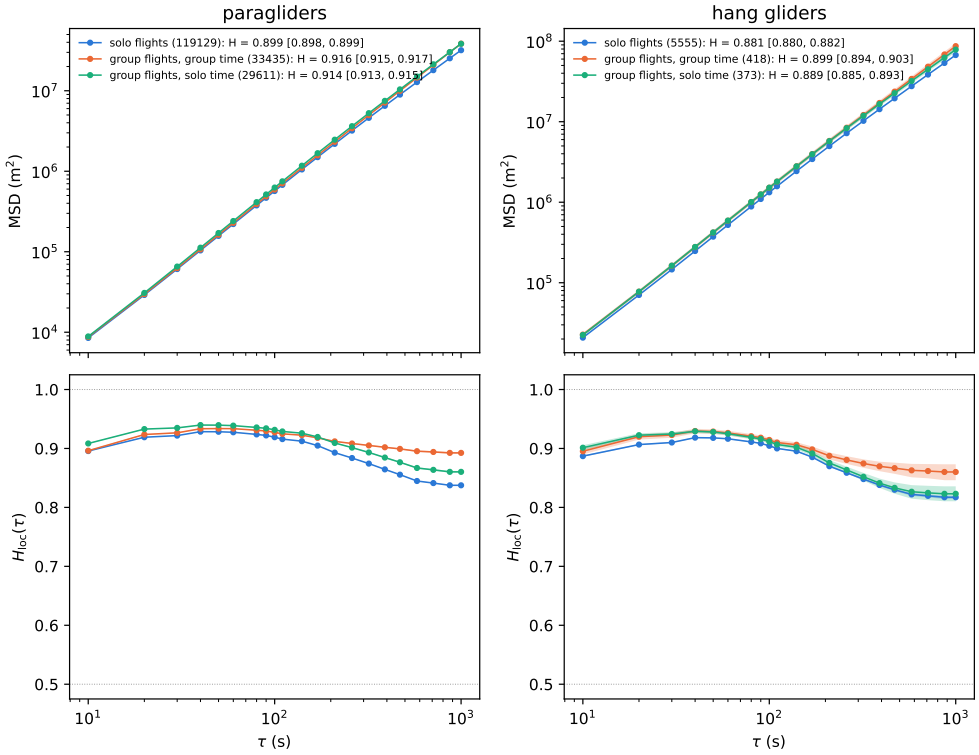


Figure 9: TA-MSD and H_{loc} of S, G and A, paragliders and hang gliders (hang gliders: 418 group flights, wide bands at long lags).

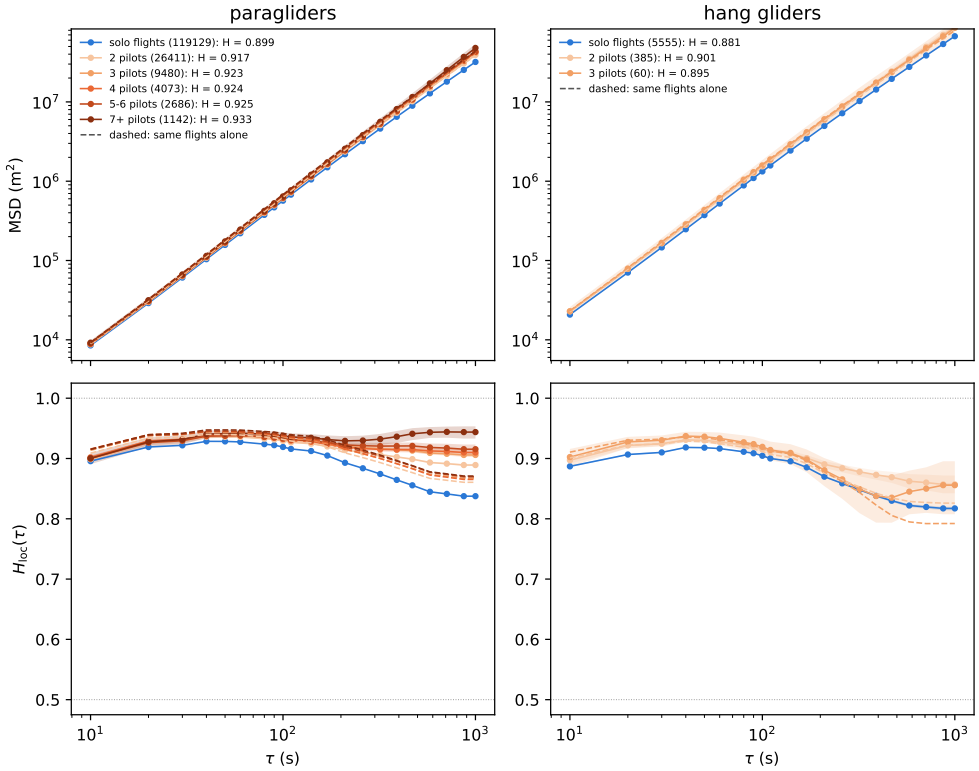


Figure 10: By the size of the group (orange, darker with more pilots), S (blue) and, dashed, the same flights alone for each size.

E Values behind the figures

The tables and figures that the summary figures of the main text replace, in the order of the text.

	solo flights S	group time G	same flights alone A
flights (TA-MSD)	119 129	33 435	29 611
H (10–1000 s)	0.899 [0.898, 0.899]	0.916 [0.915, 0.917]	0.914 [0.913, 0.915]
$H_{loc}(100\ s)$	0.919 [0.919, 0.919]	0.927 [0.927, 0.928]	0.932 [0.931, 0.932]
$H_{loc}(1000\ s)$	0.837 [0.837, 0.838]	0.893 [0.891, 0.894]	0.860 [0.859, 0.862]
time in climb (%)	30.8 [30.7, 30.9]	33.0 [32.8, 33.2]	29.1 [28.9, 29.2]
searches ending in a climb (%)	43.3 [43.2, 43.4]	49.5 [49.2, 49.7]	45.9 [45.7, 46.1]
climb rate (m/s)	1.22 [1.22, 1.22]	1.26 [1.25, 1.27]	1.33 [1.32, 1.34]
glide speed (km/h)	30.1 [30.1, 30.2]	33.3 [33.1, 33.5]	32.8 [32.6, 32.9]
glide ratio	10.4 [10.4, 10.4]	12.9 [12.8, 13.0]	11.3 [11.2, 11.4]
cross-country speed (km/h)	17.2 [17.2, 17.3]	20.0 [19.8, 20.3]	20.0 [19.8, 20.1]

Table 4: Pooled statistics of S, G and A (paragliders), with 5–95% bands (Figure 1). Exponents on loggers of at most 10 s, phases on 1 Hz flights.

Δ	G − S pooled	G − S same s-d-h	A − S same s-d-h	G − A same flight	G − A same s-d-h
$H_{loc}(100\ s)$	+0.008 [+0.007, +0.009]	+0.002 [+0.001, +0.003]	+0.005 [+0.004, +0.005]	−0.009 [−0.009, −0.008]	+0.002 [+0.001, +0.002]
$H_{loc}(1000\ s)$	+0.055 [+0.053, +0.057]	+0.041 [+0.038, +0.044]	+0.003 [+0.001, +0.006]	+0.037 [+0.035, +0.039]	+0.043 [+0.040, +0.046]
time in climb (%)	+2.20 [+1.96, +2.45]	+3.43 [+3.19, +3.63]	+0.43 [+0.25, +0.59]	+5.71 [+5.52, +5.92]	+3.28 [+3.11, +3.47]
searches to climb (%)	+6.18 [+5.82, +6.46]	+4.12 [+3.68, +4.54]	+1.60 [+1.23, +1.97]	+8.75 [+8.37, +9.15]	+2.59 [+2.25, +2.99]
climb rate (m/s)	+0.040 [+0.030, +0.051]	+0.031 [+0.025, +0.039]	+0.007 [+0.001, +0.012]	+0.024 [+0.019, +0.031]	+0.029 [+0.025, +0.034]
glide speed (km/h)	+3.18 [+2.97, +3.39]	+1.97 [+1.82, +2.10]	+1.15 [+1.05, +1.27]	+1.36 [+1.27, +1.46]	+0.87 [+0.79, +0.98]
height lost per km (m/km)	−18.6 [−19.3, −17.8]	−10.0 [−10.7, −9.1]	−0.5 [−1.1, +0.3]	−21.1 [−22.1, −20.1]	−9.5 [−10.5, −8.6]
cross-country speed (km/h)	+2.81 [+2.59, +3.01]	+2.25 [+2.09, +2.39]	+1.31 [+1.21, +1.43]	+0.70 [+0.60, +0.78]	+1.29 [+1.16, +1.41]

Table 5: The five contrasts of Section 4 (Figure 2): difference and 5–95% band (s-d-h: same site-day and hour).

compared within	G kept (%)	fitted H (10–1000 s) G	S | G	A | G	ΔH G − S as is	G − S reweighted	G − A reweighted	ΔH_{loc}(1000 s) G − S as is	G − S reweighted	G − A reweighted
none	100	0.916	0.899	0.914	+0.017	+0.017 [+0.016, +0.018]	+0.002 [+0.001, +0.003]	+0.055	+0.055 [+0.053, +0.057]	+0.032 [+0.030, +0.034]
zone	100	0.919	0.902	0.916	+0.021	+0.018 [+0.017, +0.019]	+0.003 [+0.003, +0.004]	+0.059	+0.056 [+0.054, +0.058]	+0.028 [+0.026, +0.029]
zone × month	99	0.919	0.902	0.915	+0.022	+0.017 [+0.016, +0.018]	+0.003 [+0.003, +0.004]	+0.064	+0.054 [+0.053, +0.057]	+0.028 [+0.027, +0.031]
zone × hour	99	0.919	0.902	0.913	+0.022	+0.017 [+0.016, +0.018]	+0.005 [+0.005, +0.006]	+0.064	+0.052 [+0.050, +0.054]	+0.026 [+0.025, +0.028]
site-day × hour	53	0.917	0.904	0.913	+0.015	+0.013 [+0.012, +0.014]	+0.008 [+0.007, +0.009]	+0.051	+0.044 [+0.041, +0.046]	+0.033 [+0.031, +0.036]

Table 6: Fitted H and differences by stratification (Figure 4). "Reweighted": the other population reweighted to the strata of G (value, 5–95% band); "as is": the same strata without reweighting. $H_{\mathrm{S|G}}$: H of S reweighted to G. The columns G and "kept" refer to the strata shared with S; on those shared with A they differ slightly.

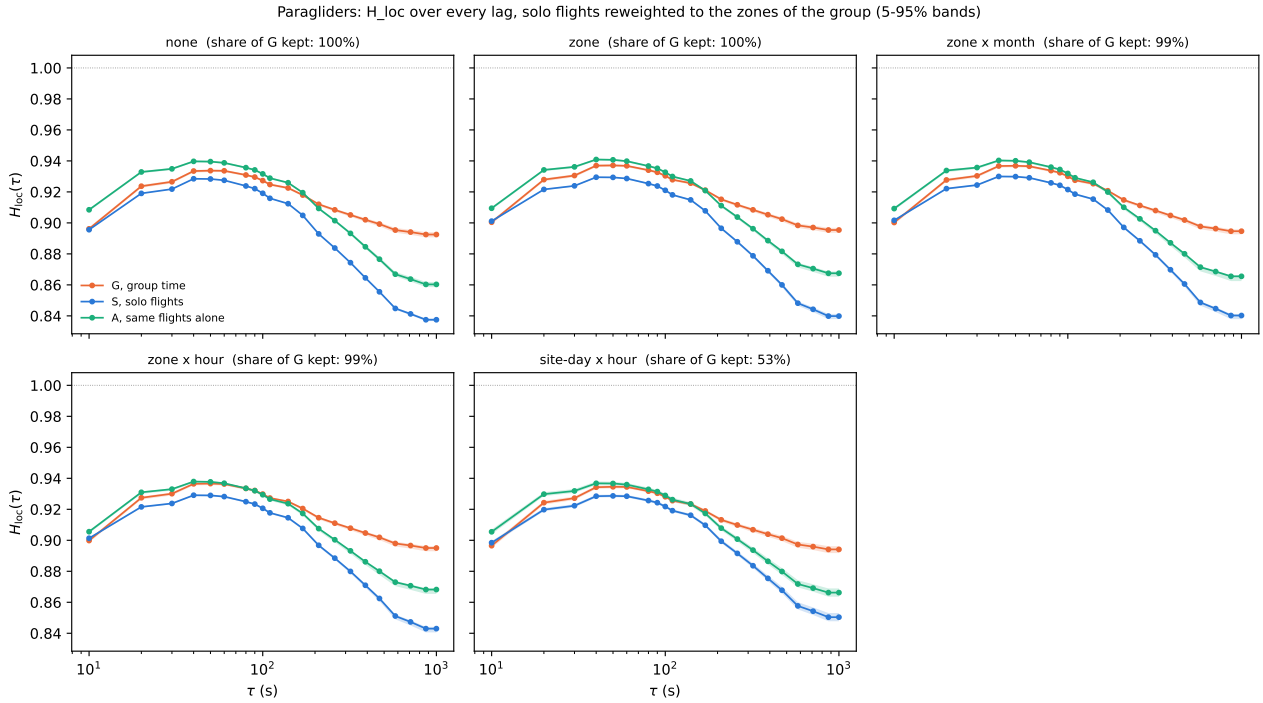


Figure 11: $H_{\mathrm{loc}}(\tau)$ of G (orange), of S reweighted to the strata of G (blue) and of A reweighted to them (green), 5–95% bands (Section 5). First panel: all flights pooled. "Share of G kept": flights of G with a solo counterpart in their stratum.

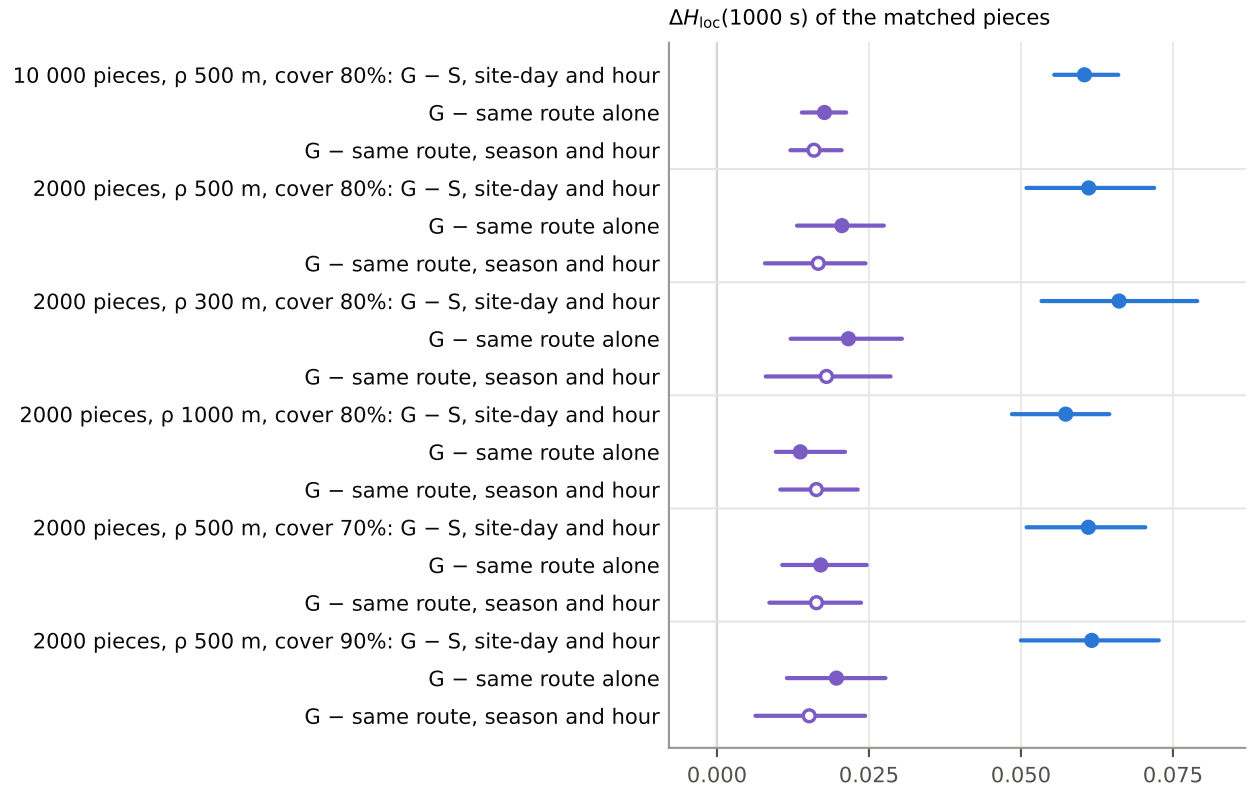


Figure 12: $\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$ of the matched pieces against the solo flights of their site-day and hour (blue) and against the same route flown alone (purple; open: same season and hour), by sample, radius ρ and cover. First block: the sample of Section 6.

ρ, cover	pieces	route, any date	route, same season and hour	site-day and hour
500 m, 80%	10 000: 4 933	+0.018 [+0.014, +0.021]	+0.016 [+0.012, +0.021]	+0.060 [+0.055, +0.066]
500 m, 80%	2 000: 958	+0.021 [+0.013, +0.027]	+0.017 [+0.008, +0.024]	+0.061 [+0.051, +0.072]
300 m, 80%	2 000: 675	+0.022 [+0.012, +0.030]	+0.018 [+0.008, +0.029]	+0.066 [+0.053, +0.079]
1000 m, 80%	2 000: 1 284	+0.014 [+0.010, +0.021]	+0.016 [+0.010, +0.023]	+0.057 [+0.049, +0.065]
500 m, 70%	2 000: 1 062	+0.017 [+0.011, +0.025]	+0.016 [+0.009, +0.024]	+0.061 [+0.051, +0.070]
500 m, 90%	2 000: 793	+0.020 [+0.012, +0.028]	+0.015 [+0.006, +0.024]	+0.062 [+0.050, +0.073]

Table 7: $\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$ of the matched pieces against the same route flown alone and against the solo flights of their site-day and hour, by radius ρ and cover (Figure 12). Pieces: drawn at random, and matched.

comparison	events	ΔH	$\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(100)$	$\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000)$
entering: start − before	6 524	+0.010 [+0.009, +0.011]	+0.005 [+0.004, +0.006]	+0.027 [+0.023, +0.031]
leaving: end − after	13 643	+0.005 [+0.004, +0.006]	−0.001 [−0.002, −0.000]	+0.031 [+0.028, +0.033]
after − before	6 320	+0.004 [+0.003, +0.005]	+0.006 [+0.005, +0.007]	−0.003 [−0.007, +0.001]
control A: later − earlier	16 998	+0.005 [+0.004, +0.005]	+0.005 [+0.005, +0.006]	−0.002 [−0.005, +0.000]
control S: later − earlier	69 648	+0.009 [+0.008, +0.009]	+0.010 [+0.010, +0.011]	−0.002 [−0.003, −0.000]

Table 8: Differences of the fitted H and of H_{loc} at 100 and 1000 s between windows, on the events with both windows (Figure 6). Controls: later minus earlier; leaving is end minus after, so its drift is the control with the opposite sign.

comparison	events	time in climb (points)	searches to climb (points)	climb rate (m/s)	glide speed (km/h)	height lost per km (m/km)
entering: start − before	4 786	+0.7 [+0.3, +1.1]	+0.0 [−1.1, +1.0]	+0.046 [+0.034, +0.062]	+0.92 [+0.69, +1.15]	−2.3 [−3.5, −1.3]
leaving: end − after	10 097	+1.5 [+1.2, +1.9]	+1.2 [+0.4, +1.9]	−0.007 [−0.017, +0.003]	+0.52 [+0.35, +0.64]	−10.9 [−11.8, −10.0]
after − before	4 718	−1.4 [−1.8, −1.0]	−2.8 [−4.0, −1.6]	+0.043 [+0.024, +0.059]	+0.33 [+0.12, +0.55]	+9.1 [+7.8, +10.4]
control A: later − earlier	12 568	−1.1 [−1.3, −0.9]	−1.4 [−2.0, −0.8]	+0.018 [+0.009, +0.027]	+0.07 [−0.05, +0.20]	+3.3 [+2.5, +4.2]
control S: later − earlier	49 092	−1.6 [−1.7, −1.5]	−2.3 [−2.7, −2.0]	+0.011 [+0.008, +0.015]	+0.04 [−0.03, +0.10]	+4.9 [+4.5, +5.3]

Table 9: The phase statistics of the same comparisons (differences with 5–95% band); runs and glides are placed in the window that holds their middle.

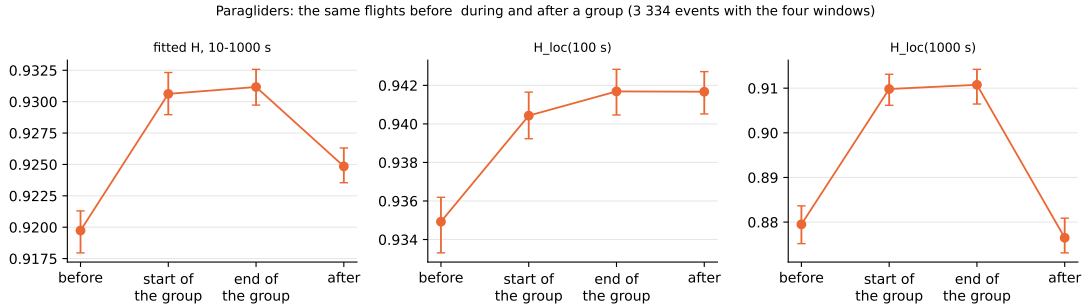


Figure 13: The four windows of Section 7 on the events that have all of them. Start and end overlap when the group lasts less than $2W$.

		H		$H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$						
pilots	flights	G_n	alone	G_n	alone	time in climb (%)	searches to climb (%)	climb rate (m/s)	glide speed (km/h)	glide ratio
solo	119 129	0.899		0.837		30.8	43.3	1.22	30.1	10.4
2	26 411	0.917	0.914	0.889	0.861	32.7	49.0	1.27	33.2	12.5
3	9 480	0.923	0.919	0.906	0.867	33.6	49.9	1.26	33.5	13.1
4	4 073	0.924	0.920	0.910	0.865	33.6	51.0	1.25	33.5	13.7
5–6	2 686	0.925	0.922	0.915	0.870	33.1	50.1	1.23	33.1	14.1
7+	1 142	0.933	0.924	0.944	0.871	34.6	51.7	1.20	34.6	15.9

Table 10: Paragliders, pooled by the size of the group ("alone": the same flights alone).

	$G_n - A$, same flight					$G_n - G_2$, same site-day-hour			
n	2	3	4	5–6	7+	3	4	5–6	7+
$H_{\mathrm{loc}}(100\ \mathrm{s})$	−0.008	−0.014	−0.012	−0.021	−0.013	−0.003	−0.002	−0.013	+0.009
$H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$	+0.026	+0.027	+0.043	+0.038	+0.087	+0.004	−0.001	−0.015	+0.064
time in climb (%)	+5.76	+8.26	+9.37	+9.11	+9.91	+1.98	+3.77	+3.54	+4.03
searches ending in a climb (%)	+8.25	+9.41	+10.78	+9.97	+11.25	+0.28	+0.55	+0.35	+1.19
climb rate (m/s)	+0.021	+0.006	−0.008	−0.012	−0.055	+0.002	−0.003	−0.006	−0.017
glide speed (km/h)	+1.29	+1.15	+1.32	+0.93	+0.96	−0.23	−0.40	−0.46	−0.18
height lost per km of glide (m/km)	−17.6	−22.8	−28.1	−32.3	−28.1	−3.0	−8.0	−8.7	−7.5

Table 11: The contrasts by size of Section 8.1 (Figure 7).

test	comparison	$\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000\ \mathrm{s})$	band
raw	G − S pooled	+0.055	[+0.053, +0.057]
pilots, day, site, hour	G − S same site-day and hour	+0.041	[+0.038, +0.044]
	A − S same site-day and hour (selection)	+0.003	[+0.001, +0.006]
	G − A same flight	+0.037	[+0.035, +0.039]
	G − A same site-day and hour	+0.043	[+0.040, +0.046]
place	G − S reweighted, site-day×hour	+0.044	[+0.041, +0.046]
	G − A reweighted, site-day×hour	+0.033	[+0.031, +0.036]
route	matched pieces − S same site-day and hour	+0.060	[+0.055, +0.066]
	matched pieces − same route alone	+0.018	[+0.014, +0.021]
	the same, same season and hour	+0.016	[+0.012, +0.021]
moment	entering, start − before	+0.027	[+0.023, +0.031]
	leaving, end − after	+0.031	[+0.028, +0.033]
	after − before	−0.003	[−0.007, +0.001]
	drift, solo time of group flights (A)	−0.002	[−0.005, +0.000]
	drift, solo flights (S)	−0.002	[−0.003, −0.000]

Table 12: Every estimate of the long-lag difference, from the raw one to the four tests. The route rows refer to the matched pieces only. The drifts are later minus earlier windows; for leaving they enter with the opposite sign.

F Before, during and after: curves and short windows

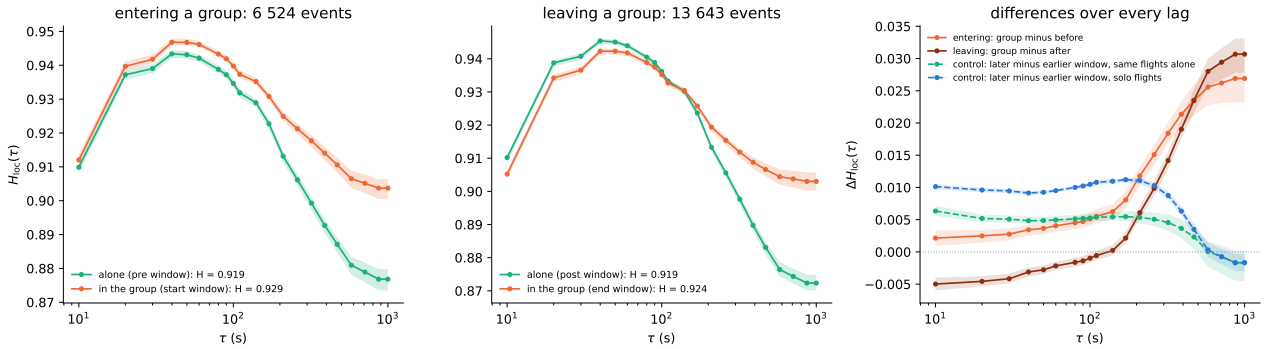


Figure 14: $H_{\mathrm{loc}}(\tau)$ of the same flights alone (green) and in the group (orange), entering (left) and leaving (middle), windows of 50 min, 5–95% bands. Right: the differences, group minus alone, with the two controls (later minus earlier window; dashed); for leaving, the drift to compare is the control with the opposite sign.

Same test as Section 7 with windows of 21 min, the shortest a piece of the TA-MSD allows. Groups of at least 21 min enter: more events, but at 1000 s a window holds fewer than thirty origins. At 1000 s entering then stays just above its drifts and leaving at them, taken with the opposite sign (−0.003 entering, +0.008 leaving, against drifts of −0.011 and −0.007); on the fitted H, dominated by short lags, entering stays below its drifts and leaving above them. The phase statistics at entry depend on the window (time in climb +3.3 points, glide speed +0.63 km/h here, against +0.7 and +0.92 with 50 min).

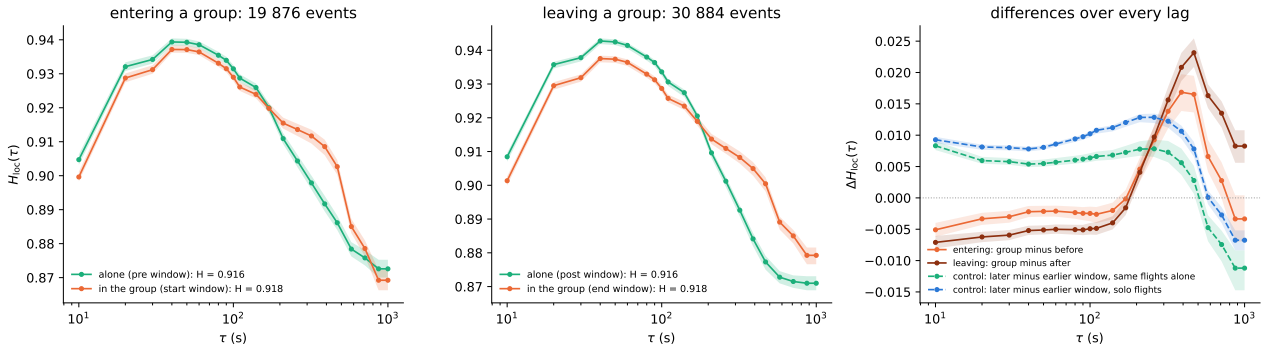


Figure 15: As Figure 14, windows of 21 min.

comparison	events	ΔH	$\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(100)$	$\Delta H_{\mathrm{loc}}(1000)$
entering: start − before	19 876	+0.002 [+0.001, +0.004]	−0.002 [−0.004, −0.001]	−0.003 [−0.007, +0.000]
leaving: end − after	30 884	+0.002 [+0.001, +0.003]	−0.005 [−0.006, −0.004]	+0.008 [+0.006, +0.011]
after − before	14 482	+0.004 [+0.003, +0.005]	+0.006 [+0.005, +0.008]	+0.002 [−0.001, +0.006]
control A: later − earlier	33 658	+0.006 [+0.005, +0.006]	+0.006 [+0.006, +0.007]	−0.011 [−0.015, −0.008]
control S: later − earlier	107 324	+0.009 [+0.009, +0.010]	+0.010 [+0.010, +0.011]	−0.007 [−0.008, −0.005]

Table 13: As Table 8, windows of 21 min.

comparison	events	time in climb (points)	searches to climb (points)	climb rate (m/s)	glide speed (km/h)	height lost per km (m/km)
entering: start − before	14 798	+3.3 [+2.9, +3.8]	+1.2 [+0.3, +2.2]	+0.043 [+0.035, +0.053]	+0.63 [+0.45, +0.77]	−8.9 [−12.1, −6.2]
leaving: end − after	23 014	+2.7 [+2.3, +3.1]	+0.9 [+0.2, +1.6]	+0.008 [+0.000, +0.018]	+0.54 [+0.42, +0.67]	−13.1 [−14.5, −11.5]
after − before	10 898	−1.5 [−2.0, −1.1]	−4.1 [−5.2, −2.9]	+0.017 [−0.001, +0.030]	+0.17 [−0.01, +0.35]	+9.6 [+5.7, +12.9]
control A: later − earlier	25 121	−2.1 [−2.4, −1.8]	−2.8 [−3.5, −2.0]	−0.001 [−0.009, +0.006]	−0.29 [−0.40, −0.15]	+3.4 [+1.9, +5.2]
control S: later − earlier	75 984	−2.0 [−2.2, −1.8]	−3.0 [−3.5, −2.7]	−0.012 [−0.017, −0.009]	−0.31 [−0.37, −0.24]	+6.2 [+5.0, +7.5]

Table 14: As Table 9, windows of 21 min.

G Single site-days

Six site-days chosen by a fixed rule (most sizes with 15 flights or more, then most flights, at most two per takeoff site). Bands resample flights (too narrow: flights of one group are not independent).

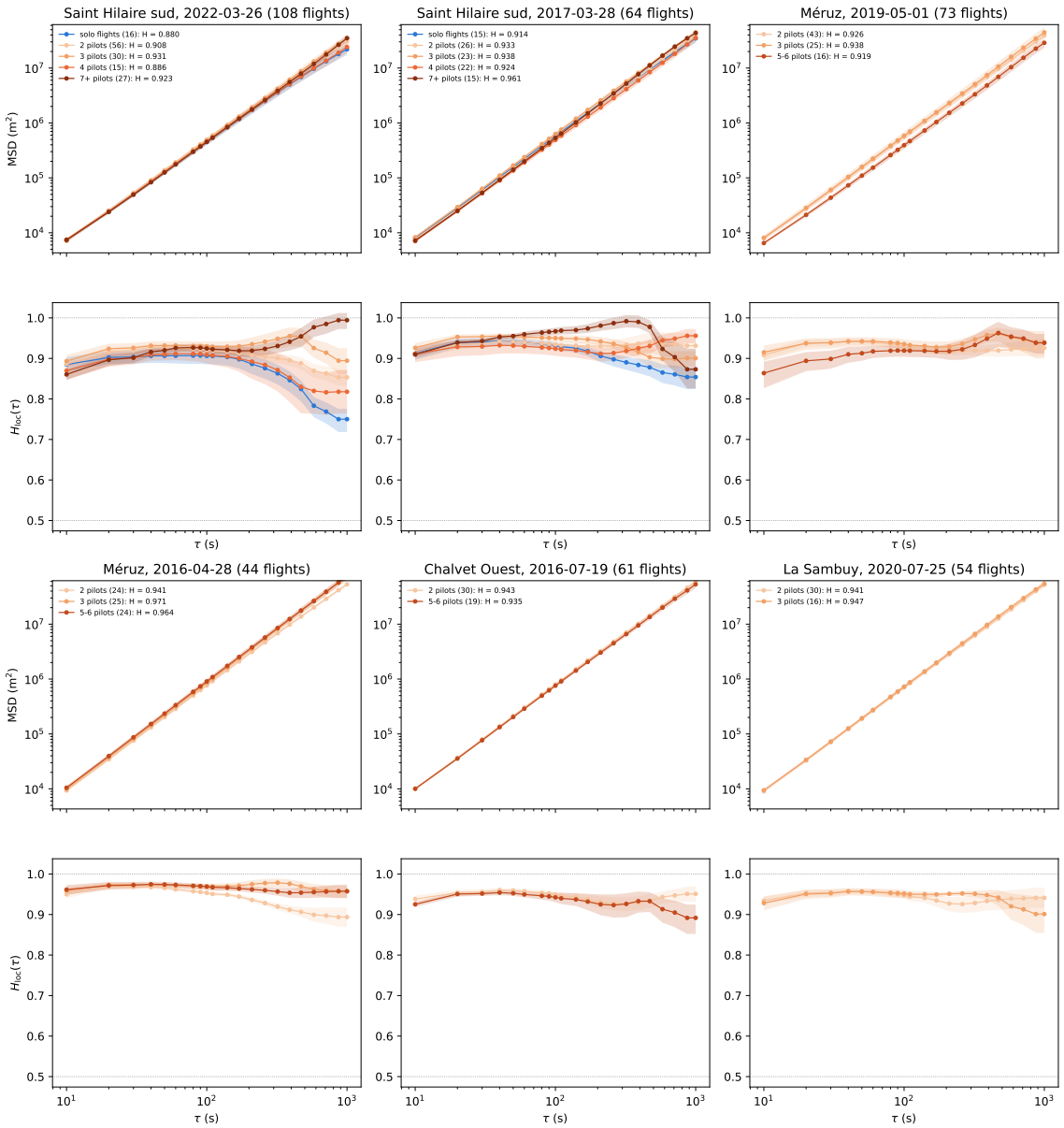


Figure 16: TA-MSD and H_{loc} on six site-days by the size of the group, with the solo flights of the same site-day where they reach 15 flights.

site-day	solo	2	3	4	5–6	7+
Saint Hilaire sud, 2022-03-26	0.750	0.853	0.894	0.818		0.994
Saint Hilaire sud, 2017-03-28	0.854	0.931	0.901	0.956		0.873
Méruz, 2019-05-01		0.926	0.939		0.938	
Méruz, 2016-04-28		0.894	0.958		0.957	
Chalvet Ouest, 2016-07-19		0.951			0.892	
La Sambuy, 2020-07-25		0.941	0.901			

Table 15: $H_{\text{loc}}(1000\text{ s})$ by size on each site-day (empty: fewer than 15 flights). Differences between days exceed those between sizes (the climb rate goes from 0.79 to 2.11 m/s across the six days).

H Leader minus follower

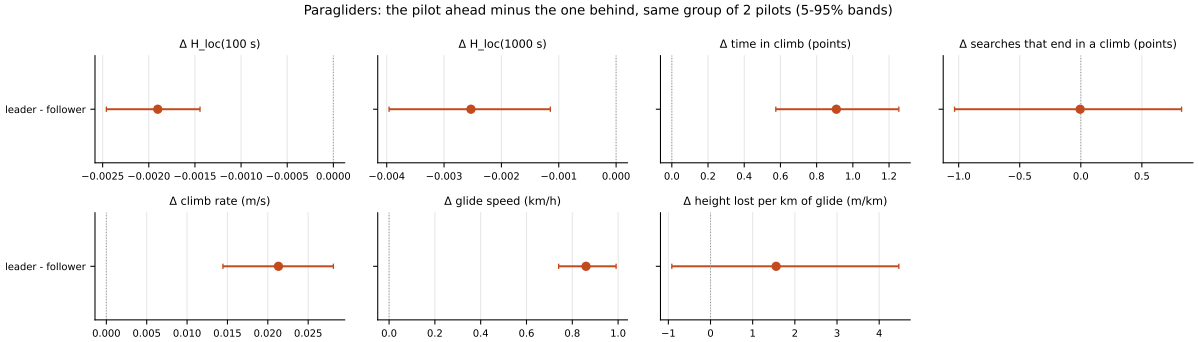


Figure 17: Leader minus follower, same group of two pilots.

Δ	leader − follower
$H_{\text{loc}}(100\ \text{s})$	-0.002 [-0.002, -0.001]
$H_{\text{loc}}(1000\ \text{s})$	-0.003 [-0.004, -0.001]
time in climb (%)	$+0.91$ [$+0.57$, $+1.25$]
searches ending in a climb (%)	-0.01 [-1.03, $+0.83$]
climb rate (m/s)	$+0.021$ [$+0.014$, $+0.028$]
glide speed (km/h)	$+0.86$ [$+0.74$, $+0.99$]
height lost per km of glide (m/km)	$+1.6$ [-0.9, $+4.5$]
cross-country speed (km/h)	$+0.14$ [$+0.11$, $+0.16$]

Table 16: Leader minus follower, same group of two pilots (difference with 5–95% band).

I Checks of the viewer and of the analyses

The checks of the grouping itself, its code against the note and the properties of its tables, are in section 8 of the note.

- **Viewer.** The *Group flights* tab reads `groups/` of its data folder: its seven tables are **byte-identical** to those of the chosen run; the tracks it draws (`SSD_DATA`) have the same fixes, times, positions and trimmed starts as those the grouping read (`SSD_DISANTE`).
- **Analyses.** Tests on synthetic flights for every step, and on every number of the README of the analyses; the decomposition is checked on a synthetic case where the day raises a statistic by 10 and the group by 2: pooled 10, stratified 2.

J Reproducing the report

From `xc-lab/analysis/groups/group-identification`, SSD_DISANTE mounted:

```
uv run python tamsd.py; uv run python phase_msd.py; uv run python survival.py
uv run python budget.py; uv run python performance.py; uv run python blocks.py
uv run python redundancy.py; uv run python size.py; uv run python decompose.py
uv run python zones.py; uv run python prepost.py; uv run python prepost.py --window 1260
uv run python mechanisms.py; uv run python report/facts.py
uv run python route.py --sample 10000
uv run python report/tables.py; uv run python report/figures.py
cd report; latexmk -pdf group_vs_solo.tex
```

Heavy pieces stay on SSD_DISANTE, in the `analyses/` folder of each run; figures and JSON in `out/<run>/`.